

09 / SEASONAL HOME SAFETY

Walk through together.

Use this to notice tasks, then ask the relevant professional about safe changes. Equipment and home adaptations should suit the person, the home and applicable requirements.

- ☐ Test smoke and carbon monoxide alarms; follow replacement and battery instructions.
- ☐ Clear and light the route from bed to bathroom.
- ☐ Check loose rugs, cords, clutter and trip edges.
- ☐ Check steps and handrails; arrange repairs where needed.
- ☐ Ask about properly installed grab bars and suitable bathroom equipment.
- ☐ Ask a qualified professional about safe hot-water delivery and scald prevention; do not change tank settings from this checklist.
- ☐ Service heating and filters according to the equipment instructions.
- ☐ Return unused or expired medication to a pharmacy for advice on disposal.

Top three concerns / professional advice needed

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Make a plan for the season.

Assign work only to someone who can do it safely. Ask contractors about the insurance, training and coverage applicable to the work.

Before cold weather

- ☐ Confirm snow and ice removal; store grit where it can be reached.
- ☐ Arrange safe gutter, drainage, outdoor tap and heating maintenance.
- ☐ Check entrance lighting, outdoor steps and handrails.

Before warm weather

- ☐ Inspect paths and porches from a safe position; arrange repairs.
- ☐ Arrange dryer-vent cleaning and check windows and screens.
- ☐ Test cooling and agree a plan for very hot days.

Task	Owner / quote	Due / confirmed